

3.1 Techniques to test/check and review animation with audio

Techniques to test/check the technical properties of animation with audio

- Methods of testing and checking
 - test plan
 - checklist
 - success criteria
- Elements of animation and audio to test/check
 - length
 - animated movement
 - audio
 - synchronisation of visual and audio elements
 - format of the product

Techniques to review the fitness for purpose of completed animation with audio

- Suitability for client requirements
- Suitability for target audience
 - suitability of content
 - accessibility
- Review of audio-visual quality, aesthetics, appeal and engagement

To include:

- The structure, content and use of test plans, checklists and success criteria
- How to record test/check results and how and when to retest
- How and why to test iteratively during both during production and post-production
- Checking the quality of visual elements e.g. frame rate, smoothness, lag
- Checking the quality of audio elements e.g. volume, mixing, distortion, clarity
- Checking synchronisation of visual and audio elements at key points in animations to make sure sounds match the visual content
- Checking the suitability of file formats used for animations with audio product against lists of compatible formats with the intended platforms, devices or distribution channels

Does not include:

- Peer or client testing/focus group feedback

To include:

- Strengths and weaknesses of created animation with audio
- Comparing created animation with audio against client briefs, client requirement lists or success criteria
- Assessing the appropriateness of chosen styles and approaches/conventions for clients and target audiences
- How to assess fitness for purpose e.g. adverts should advertise; promotions should promote

Does not include:

- Client/peer/focus group feedback or review, questionnaires, vox pop

Unit R096: Animation with audio

3.2 Improvements and further developments

Constraints which limit the effectiveness of animation with audio

- Animation with audio constraints
 - time
 - resources
 - hardware
 - software
 - skills
- Animation with audio improvements
 - overall style and design
 - quality
 - content and concept
 - animation/visuals
 - audio

Further development opportunities for animation with audio

- Further developments
 - length
 - product type and placement
 - story/narrative content
 - reusing components
 - cross platform media

To include:

- How the quality of created animation with audio is constrained by time, resources, hardware, software, budget, legislation, skills
- The feasible improvements to created animations with audio in terms of client requirements and target audience engagement

To include:

- How successful animations with audio can lead to repeat business/further commissions from a client
- How different resources, software, budget and skills could help animation with audio to be developed further
- How to devise further developments in terms of client requirements and target audience

Marking criteria

[Section 6.4](#) provides full information on how to mark the NEA units and apply the marking criteria below. The marking criteria descriptor words are further explained in [Appendix B](#).

The tables below contain the marking criteria for the tasks for this unit. If a student's work does not meet any Mark Band 1 (MB1) criteria for the task, you must award zero marks for that task.

Unit R096 – Topic Area 1: Plan animation with audio		
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Produces a basic interpretation of the client brief. Explanation of how the intended product meets the client brief and why it appeals to the target audience is limited .	Produces an adequate interpretation of the client brief. Explanation of how the intended product meets the client brief and why it appeals to the target audience is sound .	Produces an effective interpretation of the client brief. Explanation of how the intended product meets the client brief and why it appeals to the target audience is comprehensive .
MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–8 marks
Produces basic pre-production and planning documentation. Pre-production and planning documentation support the creation of few elements of the final product.	Produces adequate pre-production and planning documentation. Pre-production and planning documentation support the creation of some elements of the final product.	Produces detailed pre-production and planning documentation. Pre-production and planning documentation support the creation of all elements of the final product.
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Demonstrates limited understanding of how assets will contribute to the effectiveness of the final product.	Demonstrates sound understanding of how assets will contribute to the effectiveness of the final product.	Demonstrates comprehensive understanding of how assets will contribute to the effectiveness of the final product.

Unit R096 – Topic Area 1: Plan animation with audio		
Unit R096 – Topic Area 2: Create animation with audio		
MB1: 1–4 marks	MB2: 5–8 marks	MB3: 9–12 marks
Use of technical skills to create the component parts is limited in its effectiveness. Conventions and creativity in the components are limited in their fitness for purpose. The range of components supports the creation of the final product in a limited way.	Use of technical skills to create the component parts is partly effective. Conventions and creativity in the components are adequate in their fitness for purpose. The range of components partly supports the creation of the final product.	Use of technical skills to create the component parts is effective . Conventions and creativity in the components are fully fit for purpose. The range of components fully supports the creation of the final product.

MB1: 1–5 marks	MB2: 6–10 marks	MB3: 11–14 marks
Use of technical skills to create the final product is limited in its effectiveness. Conventions and creativity are applied in the final product in a limited way. Final product is limited in its fitness for purpose.	Use of technical skills to create the final product is partly effective. Conventions and creativity are adequately applied in the final product. Final product is adequately fit for purpose.	Use of technical skills to create the final product is effective. Conventions and creativity are effectively applied in the final product. Final product is fully fit for purpose.
MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–8 marks
Formats of the saved/exported components are limited in their appropriateness. Properties and format(s) of the final product are limited in their appropriateness.	Formats of the saved/exported components are adequate in their appropriateness. Properties and format(s) of the final product are adequate in their appropriateness.	Formats of the saved/exported components are clearly appropriate. Properties and format(s) of the final product are clearly appropriate.

Unit R096 – Topic Area 1: Plan animation with audio

Unit R096 – Topic Area 3: Review animation with audio

MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–7 marks	MB3: 8–10 marks
Testing/checking is limited in its effectiveness in reviewing technical properties. Review demonstrates limited understanding of the effectiveness of the final product for client and target audience.	Testing/checking is partly effective in reviewing technical properties. Review demonstrates sound understanding of the effectiveness of the final product for client and target audience.	Testing/checking is fully effective in reviewing technical properties. Review demonstrates critical understanding of the effectiveness of the final product for client and target audience.
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Recommendations demonstrate limited understanding of areas for improvement and further development. Recommendations have limited explanation.	Recommendations demonstrate sound understanding of areas for improvement and further development. Recommendations are partly explained.	Recommendations demonstrate comprehensive understanding of areas for improvement and further development. Recommendations are fully explained.

Task 1

Strand 1a

For Mark Band (MB)1, students may have simply stated the chosen audience and restated the client. An explanation of the content or chosen style of the animation with audio with reference to the client brief would be more appropriate for MB2 or MB3. An explanation of only one or two ways in which the intended product meets the client brief and appeals to the target audience would be suitable for MB1. MB3 could be achieved by explaining a few ways in great detail (depth) or by explaining many ways concisely (breadth). Diagrammatic representations would illustrate the interpretation but would not be sufficient on their own to fulfil the requirement to explain for the upper mark bands.

When interpreting the brief, students need to make decisions independently. Although it is to be expected that different students may make similar decisions and develop similar ideas, it would be highly unusual for all students in a cohort to have identical work.

Strand 1b

Pre-production documentation for the animation with audio could be presented in a number of different formats. Basic planning for MB1 may cover only the sequence of visual elements and an indication of the types of sounds which accompany the animation, whereas detailed planning for MB3 would be expected to include depth in both the animation and audio together with how they are to be combined. It would be unlikely for any single pre-production document to cover 'all' elements of the final animation with audio, and different types of planning document would be expected in order to meet the criteria for the higher mark bands.

Students must not be directed to complete specific planning tasks but may be referred to the teaching and learning content for the unit. When planning their animation with audio and justifying their design choices, students need to make decisions independently. Although it is to be expected that different students may make similar decisions and develop similar ideas, it would be highly unusual for all students in a cohort to have identical work.

Strand 1c

This strand requires students to demonstrate understanding of how assets contribute to the effectiveness of the animation with audio. A list of assets could be credited in MB1, but would not demonstrate understanding. A consideration of the technical properties of the assets chosen and reference to how the style or type of assets would appeal to the target audience or match the conventions of the product genre could contribute to meeting the requirements for MB3.

Task 2

Strand 2a

The component parts in this instance are the visual elements and the audio assets. When creating the visual components, technical skills might be used to make sure the images are suitable formats and sizes. For the audio components, file format, size and clarity of the sounds would need to be suitable for the upper mark bands. The audio assets may be mixed and edited together using a range of technical skills of appropriate software in order to meet the criteria for MB3. Digital graphics and animation skills would contribute to the upper mark bands when creating the visual component parts. Fitness for purpose in terms of conventions and creativity for MB3 could be credited if the visual and audio content matches the genre and product type set out in the client brief. Where either the audio or visual components are a poor match in terms of genre or type a mark in the lower band would be suitable. Components support the creation of the final product by virtue of their range and their properties. To fully support the creation of the final product for MB3, assets would need to be complete and technically fit for purpose. Few assets or types, or many assets but with limited technical suitability would be appropriately assessed in MB1.

Strand 2b

For MB1, the final product may be simplistic, incomplete or limited in its suitability for the client brief. Some evidence of the tools used to create the animation with audio would support marks for this strand particularly if the product is not finished or exported. Students might present screenshots to show the technical skills and tools of the software in use during the creation process. This is particularly helpful to credit some marks if the editing software is unavailable to assessors and the final product is not exported. An original idea which does not follow the conventions of the product type specified in the client brief would fit the criteria for MB1 in this strand for the conventions used and creativity. For credit in the upper mark bands both creativity and conventions should be evident in the final product. Fitness for purpose could be achieved by ensuring the final product is of a suitable length and uses the content specified by the client. Typographical errors and omissions would limit fitness for purpose and so consequently the mark for this descriptor would not be placed in the upper band.

When creating their animation with audio, students must make decisions independently. They must apply what they have learnt and not be led through a process to create an animation with audio. Students must not be directed to use particular software or software tools and/or techniques.

Strand 2c

This strand assesses the appropriateness of the components (the visual and audio assets) and the final product (the finished animation with audio). In order to meet the criteria for MB3, the images and sounds should all be saved using appropriate formats and properties so that they can be combined in the final product. Where the final product does not combine animation and audio or is not exported from the native software, MB1 would be appropriate. For MB3, the naming of the final product file would contribute, to demonstrate relevance to the client and make sure it is clearly appropriate. This criterion could also be supported by evidence that the file properties of the animation with audio are suitable for the output method or platform specified in the client brief.

When exporting their animation with audio, students need to independently decide on suitable electronic formats and properties.

Task 3

Students must produce their own review. They must apply what they have learnt and not be led through a process of reviewing their completed animation with audio.

Strand 3a

Review of the technical properties of the audio and animation components and the finished product could be presented as a completed test plan. At MB1 this may only outline a few tests, or may be limited by testing only one component (the visuals or the audio). If results and retests are considered this would contribute to MB2. An outline of how errors were resolved or prioritised for resolution might be expected at the upper end of the mark range. The components and product could be checked instead of or as well as testing. Evidence to support checking could include an account of how elements were watched or listened to, compared with the plans and designs and client brief and edited accordingly. To be fully effective for MB3, the technical properties should be considered comprehensively. The second descriptor assesses understanding of the effectiveness of the animation with audio for the client and target audience. If only the client or target audience are considered, a mark in MB1 may be suitable, whereas for MB3 both client and target audience, and the animation and audio as a single final product should be considered. For the upper mark bands, students should have explained how and why the final product would be effective. A test plan on its own would not evidence understanding of effectiveness, only functionality; so, some form of account or explanation would be expected for the upper mark bands.

Strand 3b

This strand requires an understanding of areas for improvement and further development, and an explanation of the recommendations. A list of aspects which failed when testing the components and product would demonstrate limited understanding for MB1. Areas for improvement and further development should be explained with reference to the client requirements and target audience engagement in order to demonstrate comprehensive understanding for MB3, and should include both visual and audio components. If the visuals or audio only are considered, a mark in MB1 would be suitable. For the upper mark bands, students may have considered amendments which would improve the effectiveness in terms of conventions as well as in technical terms. Since there is no requirement for a prescribed number of improvements and developments, a few aspects considered and explained in extensive detail could nevertheless meet the criteria for MB3.

Topic Area		Topic Area	
1	Plan animation with audio	2	Factors influencing product design
		3	Pre-production planning
2	Create animation with audio	3	Pre-production planning
		4	Distribution considerations
3	Review animation with audio	2	Factors influencing product design
		3	Pre-production planning
		4	Distribution considerations

More information about synoptic assessment within this qualification can be found in [section 5.2 Synoptic assessment](#).